fine art and later on was used by Kennedy and Khrushchev, during the détente days, through hotline.

Diplomacy by Conference: In the post-War period, international conferences have proliferated in the conduct of foreign policies and have assumed greater significance than normal channels of diplomacy through foreign offices and diplomatic and consular establishments. These, in most parts, involve periodic meetings of regional and international organizations attended by a number of representatives of the member states and sometimes the non-member states too. The stimulus to this form of diplomacy was provided by the League of Nations after the First World War. A number of conferences followed the post-First World War period, such as the Paris Peace Conference (1918), the Disarmament Conference at Geneva (1927), the London Conference (1930), and others. During the Second World War, a number of important conferences were held. The most noteworthy among them are: the Teheran Conference (1943), the Bretton Woods Conference (1944), The Yalta Conference (1945), and the San Francisco Conference (1945). Contemporary international relations have witnessed a number of conferences pertaining to disarmament, nuclear regimes, sustainable development and environmental issues.

Parliamentary Diplomacy: Kenneth W. Thompson has pointed out that there has been a “novel, revolutionary and worldwide institutionalizing of diplomacy”. This has generally been the result of three developments, which are quite striking:

1. Increasing incidence of public multilateral negotiations
2. Expansion of diplomatic activity into the cultural and educational fields
3. Multiplication of informal channels of contact among people and nations.

These factors have led to the growing importance of what has been called ‘parliamentary diplomacy’. Dean Rusk (Parliamentary Diplomacy—Debate vs. Negotiation, *World Affairs Interpreter*, XXVI, Summer, 1955) suggested that this type of multilateral negotiation involves “a continuing organization”, a “regular public debate exposed to the media of mass communication”, “rules of procedure